

Currents

Guide 4 of 6

TL;DR

Currents is the firm's live commentary surface. It pulls public events in from X, decides whether the firm's corpus has anything substantive to say, and either writes a citation-grounded opinion or abstains. Every published opinion respects a set of structural invariants that prevent it from speaking outside the corpus or revealing private material. This guide explains the pipeline, the invariants, and how to read an opinion's audit trail.

You will need

- A signed-in Codex session for the operator surfaces, or an anonymous browser session for the public `/currents` page.
- Familiarity with how principles and conclusions work — see Guide 2.

This guide does NOT cover

- Setting up the X bearer token and the Cloudflare tunnel — see `docs/operator/CURRENTS.md`.
- Operator overrides (kill switch, revocation) — Guide 6.
- The Oracle's question-answering surface — Guide 3.

1 What Currents is

Currents is a separate origin from the main Codex. The public page is `/currents`; the founder-facing controls live inside the Codex under `/(authed)/founder-currents`. Each “Current” is one `EventOpinion` row written by the firm in response to one outside event.

[screenshot screenshots/04_currents_public_feed.png not yet captured — The public `/currents` feed, with two opinions visible and one event in abstention.]

2 The pipeline

The pipeline is documented authoritatively in `docs/currents/PIPELINE.md` and operator-side in `docs/operator/CURRENTS.md`. Summary, top to bottom:

1. **Discovery.** The X recent-search endpoint is asked for recent high-engagement posts (and founder-curated accounts as a side channel). Configured search queries are available as targeted augmentation, not as the default seed.
2. **Significance floor.** Posts below the significance and raw engagement floors are dropped.
3. **Persistence + dedupe.** A surviving post becomes a `CurrentEvent`. Duplicates of an existing event are suppressed.

4. **Enrichment.** Embeddings, near-duplicate matching, topic enrichment.
5. **KB relevance gate.** Event embeddings are compared against the corpus. If fewer than three relevant conclusions are found, the event abstains explicitly — it does not become an opinion.
6. **Opinion generation.** The generator retrieves up to twelve firm conclusions and requires at least three to clear the relevance threshold. The LLM is required to cite each one inline as `[C:<id>]`.
7. **Publication.** `/v1/currents` on the FastAPI backend returns the resulting `EventOpinion`; the Next.js `/api/currents` route proxies it onto the public `/currents` page.

3 The eight invariants

A published Currents opinion must satisfy all eight of the following structural invariants. They are enforced by the generator and the publish path; an opinion that fails any one of them is rejected before it reaches the public feed.

1. **Grounded.** Every non-trivial claim in the opinion text is backed by an inline `[C:<id>]` citation to a firm Conclusion or Principle. Free-floating assertions are not allowed.
2. **Source-respecting.** Citations resolve only to publicly-safe corpus surfaces. Private transcripts and documents may inform internal reasoning but must not appear as public citation targets.
3. **Quorum.** At least three relevance-cleared firm conclusions back the opinion. If the corpus cannot supply three, the system abstains rather than under-cite.
4. **Voice-consistent.** The opinion is written in the firm's first-person voice rather than recapping or paraphrasing the source post. The article surface is `EventOpinion`, not raw `CurrentEvent`.
5. **Event-anchored.** Each opinion is bound to exactly one `CurrentEvent`. Multi-event commentary lives in the articles pipeline, not in Currents.
6. **Revocable.** Every opinion is publishable iff `revokedAt` IS NULL. Operator revocation is the canonical inverse of publication; there is no separate `isPublic` flag.
7. **Abstention-honest.** When the relevance gate fails, the system records an `abstentionReason` on the event and surfaces "the firm does not yet have enough material to comment." Abstentions are a public stance.
8. **Provenance-complete.** Each opinion ships an audit trail: the source post, the relevance scores, the conclusions cited, and the generator parameters. The audit trail is addressable from the public page.

4 Reading the audit trail

Open any opinion at `/currents/<id>`. Below the body you will find:

- **Source post.** The original X post the opinion responds to. Always present, always external.
- **Cited conclusions.** A list of `[C:<id>]` references, each click-through to the firm's Conclusion on the public site.
- **Relevance scores.** The score each cited conclusion had against the source event at generation time.
- **Generator metadata.** Model identifier, prompt version, retrieval window, timestamp.

- **Revocation banner** (if revoked). The opinion is hidden from the feed but its row and audit trail remain readable for accountability.

[screenshot screenshots/04_currents_audit.png not yet captured — The audit trail block at the bottom of a Currents opinion.]

5 Operator surfaces

- **OperatorPulse** card on the founder dashboard — green when the token and at least one ingestion path are configured, a scheduler cycle has reported, and the last 24 hours contain both events and opinions. Red lists the precise missing link.
- `/(authenticated)/founder-currents` — per-opinion operator controls: revoke, hold for review, adjust event-level metadata.
- `noosphere/scripts/diagnose_currents_pipeline.py` — non-writing diagnostic. Prints booleans, counts, and errors only; never prints the bearer token. Run this before blaming the UI.
- `CURRENTS_X_INGESTION_DISABLED=true` — kill switch. See Guide 6.

6 Common failure modes

- **No opinions in 24 hours.** Likely either an X token problem or a corpus-relevance problem. Check **OperatorPulse** first; it disambiguates.
- **Opinions look like they are recapping rather than opining.** Check that you have at least a few firm conclusions in the topic area. The generator falls back to thinner prose when its conclusion retrieval comes back near-empty.
- **An opinion cites a private document.** This is a violation of invariant 2 and should not happen. Revoke the opinion immediately and file a critique — see Guide 6.

7 Where the docs are

- `docs/operator/CURRENTS.md` — operator notes and environment-variable reference.
- `docs/currents/PIPELINE.md` — the canonical pipeline diagram.
- `docs/operator/public_surfacing.md` — the surface table, including the EventOpinion row.

Where to read next

Continue with [Guide 5 — Forecasts and Portfolio](#) for the prediction-market and equities surfaces, which share Currents' grounding principles but add a much stricter operator confirmation flow.